EAST COAST SHOWDOWN

A BHANGRA & GARBA-RAAS DANCE COMPETITION

BHANGRA REGISTRATION PACKET

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WELCOME TO ECS!

Dear East Coast Showdown Applicant,

The East Coast Showdown (ECS) Executive Board at the University of Virginia is proud to announce our tenth annual Bhangra and Garba-Raas competition! With the success of the past nine years, East Coast Showdown is excited to be even bigger and better this year. The competition will be held on February 20th, 2027 at the MLK Performing Arts Center in Charlottesville, VA. Our competition aims to increase awareness of South Asian culture while also uniting the community by showcasing these two different dance forms. We are proud to announce our continued partnership with Sakhi. All the proceeds of ECS 2027, net operating expenses, will be donated to Sakhi in order to support our international community.
Our executive board consists of individuals with dance experience from many different backgrounds who are excited to celebrate the diverse cultures of South Asia. We understand the hard work that goes into cultivating a team, and we would like to honor that by striving to provide one of the best experiences in the circuit while satisfying all teams' needs. We would like to thank you for your interest in ECS and would be honored to have your team participate in our competition. We can't wait to see what your team has to offer and bring you a weekend filled with fun, competition, and southern hospitality!

In this packet you will find:

- Important Timelines
- Audition Video Guidelines
- Application Fees
- Registration Information
- Rules & Regulations
- And Much More

Please read all the information carefully and keep in mind that all of the deadlines will be strictly followed. Again, we would like to thank you for your interest in the East Coast Showdown Competition. We are looking forward to working with you and hope that you have an amazing experience with us! Feel free to contact us with any questions or concerns at ecs.reg@gmail.com. We ask that you send all application and registration relate

Meera Shah and Sanjum Sandhu
ECS Registration Chairs 2026-2027

Neha Amarnath, Ronit Shah, and Sanjana Rao
East Coast Showdown Directors

CHECKLIST

Early Application	**Wednesday, October 28, 2026, 11:59 EST**	• Application on Ekta Audition Video • $80 Non-Refundable Application Fee
Regular Application	**Wednesday, November 18, 2026, 11:59 EST**	• Application on Ekta Audition Video • $90 Non-Refundable Application Fee
Late Application	**Saturday, November 21, 2026, 11:59 EST**	• Application on Ekta Audition Video • $100 Non-Refundable Application Fee
Acceptance Notification	**Wednesday, December 2, 2026, 11:59 EST**	--
Acceptance Confirmation	**Friday, December 4, 2026, 11:59 EST**	• Email Confirmation • Submit Security Deposit of $200
Waitlist Acceptances	**Rolling**	--





COMPETITION FORMAT

MIXER DAY

- Teams are required to arrive by 4 PM on Friday, February 19th, 2027 to attend prop setup and the mandatory team mixer.
- Teams must stay at the designated East Coast Showdown hotel.
- Team Captains are required to attend a captains' meeting after the mixer.

COMPETITION DAY

- A mandatory tech rehearsal at the show venue will take place on Saturday. Each team will be assigned 17 minutes of stage time. Following that, teams will have 10 minutes to watch their onstage rehearsal video and an additional 15 minutes of offstage rehearsal.
- The total length of performance must be a minimum of 7 minutes and a maximum of 9 minutes.
- Each team will be given 1.5 minutes to set up and take down props.
- The Intro Video may not exceed 1.5 minutes.

TEAM FORMAT

- A minimum of 12 people must be on the roster not including alternate dancers.
- Additional roster members after 20 members must pay an additional fee per dancer.
- All roster members must submit (1) a government-issued ID and (2) a student ID (unless affiliated with an independent team).
- Student and government IDs must be uploaded in the following format (.jpg or .png)
  i. TeamName_FirstNameLastName_StudentID ii. TeamName_FirstNameLastName_GovernmentID

PRIZE INFO

1st Place	$1000
2nd Place	$500
3rd Place	$350

HOW TO APPLY

Early Applications	**$80**	**Wednesday, October 28, 2026, 11:59 EST**
Regular Applications	**$90**	**Wednesday, November 18, 2026, 11:59 EST**
Late Applications	**$100**	**Saturday, November 21, 2026, 11:59 EST**

1. Fill out the Team Application Ekta.
   - Form link:
   - Preliminary Roster Form: Available on the Application Ekta and must be submitted in .pdf format
     - Please note team captains and managers in parentheses next to their name
     - Please note that this is a preliminary roster and teams will have the option of editing the roster if accepted to perform at ECS 2027.
   - Team photos must be at least 1920 by 1080 pixels and team logos must be at least 300 by 300 pixels. All images must be in .jpeg or .png format with the following name format.
     A. TeamName_Photo
     B. TeamName_Logo
2. Submit the NON-refundable application fee.

- **Venmo**: @eastcoastshowdownUVA
- **Zelle**: eastcoastshowdown.uva@gmail.com
  - Please make the payment private!
  - Include, in this order: Team Name, “Bhangra,” and Regular or Late Application
  - Please submit the correct amount based on the date you are submitting all your application materials by.
  - The date we receive the payment will be used to determine whether your application will be considered regular or late.

If you cannot zelle or venmo please contact us via email or text so we can work out a different payment method.

3. Submit an audition video.
   - Requirements for the video and submission are on the following pages.

All registration items must be submitted via the Application Ekta by 11:59 PM EST on the above dates. Once ALL of these materials have been received, you will receive a confirmation email from the registration chairs within 24 hours of submission.

AUDITION VIDEO

VIDEO REQUIREMENTS

1. The video MUST be continuous dancing for 2:00- 4:00 minutes
2. There MUST be at least ONE prop segment.
3. The routine performed MUST reflect the current routine that is intended to be performed at each competition. Previous routines or performances will not be considered.
4. 100% of the audition video dancers must be present in the video at all times, and their full bodies MUST be visible.
5. At least 80% of the roster members who were listed on the submitted dancing roster MUST be performing in the video.
6. All dancers MUST wear the same colored shirt to allow for visualization (either black/white) and black bottoms (shorts/pants).
7. Camera MUST be fixed. There can only be one camera angle (front and center), and it cannot be zoomed or panned.
8. All formations MUST be visible.
9.

VIDEO RESTRICTIONS

1. No vardi or props are allowed in the video, except for saaps/khunde/kato/etc.
2. No stunts, themes, dialogue, or voiceovers are permitted, though overlay of the mix audio is permitted.
3. No intro/outro videos are allowed.
4. The video cannot be edited (MUST be continuous).
5. The video cannot have any special lighting or visual effects.
6. The audio and video must be good.
7. College/university or team-affiliated items MUST not be worn or seen in the video. This includes, but is not limited to: logo, mascot, symbol, slogan, colors, etc.

8.

VIDEO SUBMISSION RULES

1. Teams may overlay the audio.
2. The audio and video MUST be of high quality (720p or above) in MP4 or .MOV format.
3. Each team MUST provide a Google Drive link to view and download an audition video.
4. The file name MUST be in the following format: “TeamName_ECS2027_BhangraAuditionVideo”.





TEAM ACCEPTANCES

Accepted Teams

Accepted teams will be notified by **Wednesday, December 2, 2026 EST**. Once accepted, your team will have until **Friday, December 4, 2026** to accept or deny your spot in the East Coast Showdown lineup.
To confirm your acceptance:

- You must pay a security deposit of **$200** within 48 hours of receiving the acceptance email.
- All fees can be paid via Venmo to @eastcoastshowdownUVA or Zelle to eastcoastshowdown.uva@gmail.com
- Please make the payment private and include the Team Name and “Raas Acceptance Fee- Security Deposit”.

Waitlisted Teams

All teams will automatically be placed on the waitlist and notified after the initial round of acceptances. Once notified, your team will have 48 hours to accept or deny your spot on the waitlist for ECS. If an opening occurs, waitlisted teams will be immediately notified and offered a spot on the lineup. Once notified, your team will have 48 hours from the time the email was sent to accept or deny your spot in the lineup. **To accept your position, you MUST pay a security deposit of $200 within 48 hours of receiving the acceptance email (venmo or zelle only).**

Security Deposit

The security deposit will be returned to you after the competition weekend is over. Money from the security deposit may be deducted if there is any damage to the hotel rooms, mixer venue, after-party venue, or performance venue. Late fees incurred due to submission of post-registration materials after deadlines and notification of passed deadlines will also result in a deduction from the security deposit.

Per Dancer Fees Post-Acceptance

- Teams will have to pay an individual fee of
  - $65 per roster member, for the first 20 dancers (dancers 1-20).
  - $75 per roster member for the next five dancers (dancers 21-25).
  - $80 per roster member for the next five dancers (dancers 26-30).
- If your team has more than 30 members on the roster, each additional member MUST pay $85 each

- Please contact registration chairs if you have more than 30 dancers.

RULES AND REGULATIONS

1. The East Coast Showdown executive board may practice discretion with their selection process. Teams understand that the committee is not required to divulge any information regarding team selection, unless they see fit.
2. Garba-Raas teams do not need to be affiliated with a particular college/university.
3. Should a registered team choose to withdraw from the competition after accepting their invitation to East Coast Showdown, they will forfeit their security deposit and paid registration fees. This means that all fees that have been paid are NON-refundable. **In addition, withdrawing AFTER the official lineup is released will result in a $350 penalty.**
4. Violence or rude behavior toward either the judges, other participants, staff at the venues and hotel, or members of the ECS board will result in point deductions or immediate disqualification, all **determined at the discretion of the ECS board.**
5. Payment of the security deposit acknowledges agreement to the outlined rules and regulations.
6. Any rules, outlined presently and in the future, that are violated will lead to an individual's or a team's disqualification, depending on the severity of the violation. The final decision will be **determined at the discretion of the ECS board.**
7. The East Coast Showdown event coordinators reserve the right to add new rules and subtract or revise existing rules as seen fit. All teams will be notified of any changes made.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Once again, on behalf of the East Coast Showdown Executive Board, we would like to thank you for your interest in our competition. We are looking forward to your application! For any questions or concerns, do not hesitate to contact the registration chairs or directors.



Meera Shah
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East Coast Showdown

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